

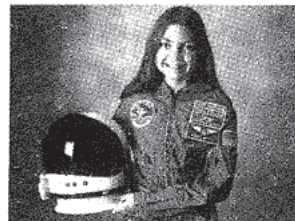
ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a webpage about a young girl who wants to be the first person to go to Mars:

Mission to Mars

Alyssa Carson, a 13-year-old girl from Louisiana, USA, is hoping to become the first person to attend all three of NASA's (National Aeronautics & Space Administration) world space camps. She plans to become the first person to visit Mars. "It's a place no one has been. A place deserted right now. I want to take that first step," she said. If all goes according to her 20-year plan, Alyssa will go on a mission to Mars in 2033.



Alyssa speaks Spanish, French and Chinese, and tweets about her trips to NASA events and space camps, and the talks she gives to inspire other children to achieve their goals. "I have thought about possibly being other things but being an astronaut was always first on my list," she says.

Alyssa's father says, "There's no doubt in my mind that her dream and passion will drive her to that planet." And NASA is taking Alyssa very seriously. NASA's Paul Foreman said of Alyssa, "She's doing the right things, taking the right training and steps to become an astronaut." Alyssa and her father have discussed the possibility of her not returning to Earth. Her father said, "If that's the only option, she still wants to go."

"I don't want one obstacle in the way to stop me from going to Mars," Alyssa says with determination. "Failure is not an option."

As members of your school's Astronomy Club, your group is planning to invite Alyssa Carson to come and give a talk to your school. You may want to talk about:

- why you would like to invite Alyssa
- what you would like Alyssa to talk about
- any other activities that could be included in Alyssa's visit
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to be an astronaut?
2. Would you like to go to Mars?
3. Do you think Alyssa Carson is too young to train to go to Mars?
4. What ambitions do you have for your future?
5. If you went to Mars, what do you think you would find there?
6. Would you like to take a trip into space on a new passenger plane?
7. If you went to Mars, what challenges do you think you would face?
8. Do you think tourism in space will ever become popular?